

Chris and Matt: A Proposal for Working Together

For Matt Campbell, from Chris Habetler. September 29, 2026.

Matt,

First, thank you for asking. I've loved working with you these last few months, and I really appreciate the trust behind it.

On the 22nd you asked what I could do, what it would look like, and what I would charge, so I took a stab at it. Read it as a starting point. I'm looking forward to talking it through and figuring out the best path together, and I expect we'll change a good bit of it.

What This Is For

- A clear working arrangement for the two of us. We've both said we want to work together, and I want the terms to match that.
- Helping you build EdTech Expertz into the empire you've talked about.
- The just-right level of support for this moment.
- Adjusting it as we go, so it grows when the business does.

I want to earn my place on your team, and I want you to feel completely comfortable asking me for whatever you need.

The Objective

The objective is to grow EdTech Expertz, in revenue and in impact. Right now the constraint is your time. You're uniquely qualified to do this work, your time is at a premium, and the business is ready to grow, but nobody has a time machine. What helps is the just-right level and type of support, from someone you know, who can add real value right away. That's what lets EdTech Expertz take on one or more additional clients, and it's a first step.

Everything from here on is a proposal. To be honest, I'm a little nervous putting numbers on paper, because I don't want to get this wrong in either direction, so forgive me in advance if anything here seems presumptuous. The only goal is an arrangement that works well for both of us, and it only works well for me if it works well for you.

How I'd Work

Operating Mindset

I'm in this with you. When you need me, I'm available. Bedtimes and family time are harder, but we'll make it work. This is a startup, and that's part of the deal.

Whatever It Takes

If it helps EdTech Expertz grow, send it my way, including things neither of us has thought of yet. The scope below is a starting picture, not a fence.

Response Time

Emails get a reply the same day. Requests get turned around within 48 hours by default, unless we agree on something different for a bigger piece of work.

Approximate Time Commitment

About a day a week to start, more in heavy weeks and less in light ones. That's here so you have a sense of what's reasonable to ask for, not to draw a line. A short weekly check-in where you set the priorities keeps us both honest on it. If it runs well past a day a week for a month or two, we look at the fee together.

Scope

What I've Heard You Need

- Research: crosswalks, diligence readouts, prep briefs on prospective clients, and people maps, whenever you need them.
- The referral network: running it day to day, including finding and vetting members, onboarding, a one-page card on each company, monthly check-ins, running the monthly meeting with you, a weekly digest so you can say yes or no in one pass, and the tracker and shared diligence folder in your Drive. Members can still come straight to you, and your clients still go through you to reach the network.
- The school-side voice in client work: sessions like Forward Edge on 10/1, messaging and language work, feedback on decks and pitches, and bringing in expert reviewers when a client needs one.
- Introductions in both directions.

For the first month, my priorities would be prep briefs on your five parked leads, the member list cleaned up, the company cards, and the first weekly digest.

High Value, Worth Considering

- Team workspace: building out the EdTech Expertz ChatGPT workspace and projects, so each client's context and our research process are set up once and reused.
- Company knowledge base: keeping an internal wiki current in Google Drive and the ChatGPT workspace.
- First meetings: joining first meetings with prospective clients to give the school-side read on their product.
- Promotional materials: one-pagers, decks, leave-behinds, and other design work.
- Outreach: reaching the mid-size publishers and platforms on your target list.

Ideas for Later

- Representing EdTech Expertz with school leaders and at conferences, or co-presenting with you.
- Working directly with a client's team (sales, customer success, product) on how they serve schools: onboarding, implementation, pilots, and renewals.
- School-leader feedback panels on a client's product.
- Training a client's sales team on how school leaders actually buy.
- Help with approvals and procurement, like the New York sponsor list and BOCES route from the Forward Edge readout.
- AI enablement for a client's team, and L&D or association work when you're ready to go after it.

When any of this is paid for by a client, we'd agree on my share before it starts.

Ownership

As with any subcontract, anything I create while working with you is yours, and it lives in your Drive or the shared workspace, prompts included. The one exception is ClassE: work I do directly for ClassE falls

under my own agreement with Joe. The company relationships, approving intros, contracts, fees, and the final call on positioning stay yours.

Proposed Fee

Starting Fee

\$2,500 a month, starting October 1 or the day AAP signs, whichever is later. The work in this proposal starts when the fee does. Benchmark and Forward Edge on 10/1 are on me either way.

How It Grows

- New business: the fee goes up by 15% of any new monthly retainer business EdTech Expertz signs after we start. For example, a new client at \$10,000 a month would raise the fee by \$1,500, to \$4,000. When a new retainer signs, tell me the monthly amount and I'll invoice the new number. Once the fee passes \$5,000, we sit down and look at the fee and the role together.
- The network: 20% of what EdTech Expertz keeps on deals that come through the referral network. That's the "grows as the sales these individuals bring in grows" piece you described on 9/16. It only applies to the network, so it never touches your core consulting, and I'll never pitch members. My own intros stay under our August agreement.
- Projects: if a client pays you for work I do most of, we agree on my share before it starts.

This is the proposal. If it's too big a swing to start, let's find a smaller one. From what I understand, you could use the support, and I sure wouldn't mind a little income.

If the Business Changes

Your business will change, and the deal should too. A few changes I can see coming:

- One very large client. A client paying \$500,000 a year would move the fee a lot under this formula, and it would probably change what you need from me. We'd sit down and reset both.
- Project work, courses, speaking, or a book. These aren't monthly retainers, so they don't move the fee. If I help build one, we agree on my share before it starts.
- A client leaves, or AAP slips. We talk about it at the next check-in rather than letting a formula decide. If AAP hasn't signed by the end of October, let's talk about starting anyway.
- You bring on more people. My role would probably shift, and we'd work out the new one together.

Checking In

This is meant to be ongoing, not a trial. The weekly check-in handles week to week. In January we'd have our first real sit-down: what I delivered, what it freed up for you, where the business and the network are, and whether the fee and the time still match the work. After that, we check in every quarter, or anytime either of us wants to.

Either of us can end it with 30 days' notice. The notice month is paid at the current fee, and you'd get a clean handoff. The network share keeps paying for 12 months on deals already logged.

Items for Conversation

1. A full-time role. I'm in late rounds for a full-time role at a charter network, and there may be others. If one happens, you'll hear it from me first, and I want to keep doing both. The work would move to before and after the school day. What we'd work out together is timing (the network check-ins are the

piece most tied to the school day) and anything a school employer would want to clear, since the network puts vendors in front of schools.

2. What you usually keep on a network deal. That number tells us whether 20% is right.
3. How many hours a week research and the network take you now.
4. The ClassE advisory. You asked on 9/16 what I'd need. Joe would pay this directly, so it doesn't touch your ClassE fee or count toward my 15%. My starting thought is \$3,000 a month, and I'd want your read on how to frame it with Joe and where that work ends and my work for you begins.
5. Which of the high-value ideas, if any, you'd want to start with.

Thank you again for asking me. Obviously there's a lot here, and I'm really looking forward to talking it through and figuring out what works best for you. Clarity is king, so push on any of it.

Chris